

Figure 4: Settings view

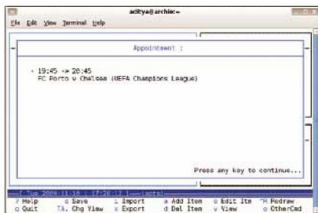


Figure 5: Detailed view of an appointment

In order to set the notifications, go to the Notify sub-menu. Here you can choose whether to display the notification bar or not, and which information to display. The important setting here is the `notify-bar_command` and `notify-bar_warning`. The `notify-bar_command` is executed `notify-bar_warning` seconds before a flagged appointment. To flag an appointment, highlight the appointment and then press 'f'. It will be marked as 'important' and the `notify-bar_command` will be executed before this appointment.

Inside the Colour sub-menu, you can change the default colour scheme. The key-bindings sub-menu lists all possible keys and their functions, which can be changed according to your need. The Layout sub-menu allows you to choose between eight predefined layouts for arranging the three windows (appointments, calendar and tasks) inside the terminal.

Import and export

This feature is by far the best feature of this application. You can export your entire calendar in iCal or Pcal format. And this can then be imported to other organisers. The import function can be used to import iCal format calendars. Currently, the import function cannot import the notifications set in the iCal format; it also cannot import the notes. This is a serious flaw, but it's in line for correction in the next update.

Multiple calendars?

It is possible to have multiple calendars using Calcurse. The default Calcurse files are created in the home directory of the user inside the `.calcurse` directory. The files are:

- `notes/` – This directory saves the notes created with the appointments and tasks.
- `conf` – This file contains the configuration settings of Calcurse.
- `keys` – This file contains the key-bindings of Calcurse.
- `apts` – This file contains the appointments.
- `todo` – This file contains the to-do (tasks) list.

As you can see, the task and appointment files are different. By simply changing the appointments file, we can have a different calendar entry, keeping the tasks constant. To change Calcurse to a new calendar, open Calcurse with an argument `-c`, that is:

```
calcurse -c PathOfTheCalendarDatabaseFile
```

And the events and appointments from this file will be available with you.

The verdict

Certainly Calcurse is not the best organiser in the world. The obvious glitches in the import function and lack of mouse support are serious problems. However, with its size being less than half a megabyte and the memory requirement also less than 16 MB, this is a gem for people with older hardware. 

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